

THE BEST SMART PLUG FOR YOUR HOME

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We can all agree that home is where the heart is.

Today, easy-to-use and helpful electronic gadgets make us feel more connected to our homes—metaphorically as well as literally. One of the starting points towards making a home smart is by using smart plugs and sockets. Smart plugs enable us to control and monitor our electrical home appliances remotely throughout the day. In this article we look at features that such smart plugs should offer for the best smart home experience, and the options available in the market.

The essentials

Any home appliance that can be plugged in can be connected to a smart plug, be it TV, set-top box, coffee machine, water purifier, water geyser or air-conditioner. The essence of a smart plug lies in its ability to provide control through mobile devices like smartphone or tablet. Hence, most smart appliances are assisted by a mobile application, allowing you to control it from anywhere, as long as you are connected to the Internet.

Another essential feature of a smart plug is its ability to schedule the powering of appliances.

It is recommended to pick a smart plug that offers data analytics and insights on energy consumption by appliances. Usually, energy consumption data measured by a plug is stored on the cloud. Accompanying software programs analyse this data and represent the same in graphical or another referable form, which is viewable through a mobile or Web-based application.

If you want to connect high-load appliances like air-conditioners or geysers, you should look for a smart plug with higher load capacity—at least 16A current input compatibility and at least 2400W (or 2.4kW) power capacity.

An interesting feature in many modern plugs is the support for voice assistants, like Google Assistant or Alexa. If you own a Google Home or an Amazon Echo, you can control the smart plug through voice.

Some plugs also provide the option to custom-program their operations via if-this-then-that (IFTTT) support. This feature can be useful if you have basic knowledge of programming logics for electronic devices.

Then there are smart plugs that come with last state feature. In this feature, when power returns after a cut, the smart plug auto-starts, using the settings it was running on before the power cut.

It is important to verify that smart plugs are compatible with the pin type of the appliances you plan to connect.

In some cases, a separate adaptor may be required.

Market options

Some popular options available in the market are mentioned in this section. You may explore other vendors as well, and pick one based on your usage needs, feature preferences and budget.

Nishica smart plug. This new entrant in the market brings a low-cost, easy-to-use device that can run any moderate-load appliance (up to 10A, 240V), like a TV, set-top box or coffee machine. It works with SmartLife mobile application (available for both Android and iOS), and has support for Amazon Alexa and Google Assistant.



It provides all essential features of a smart plug, like setting schedules, remote control of appliances and checking power on or off status in real time. A power button allows you to run it manually. It is available for ₹ 999.

WIQD smart Wi-Fi plug. This smart plug offering from WIQD is simple to use and can run up to 2200W

